Give the code a clear place in the review.

CodeRabbit Change Stack | Product design take-home
Parth Pawar | October 19, 2026

A reviewer needs to know where they are, understand the change, and decide what to do next. This redesign keeps layer-based review while giving navigation, code, and explanations distinct roles.

Observed in the supplied screen	Design decision and expected benefit
Several toolbars compete with the diff.	A compact PR header carries the final review action. One file toolbar holds layout, focus, and viewed status. Tools proposes secondary placements; those workflows are not prototyped.
Layer and file navigation are separated.	Expandable files sit under their layer. The selected layer, file, and dependency remain visible together, reducing the need to reconstruct location.
Summaries are detached from their code ranges.	Selecting a summary reveals and highlights its code. Matching selection treatments connect explanation and evidence; diff signs remain visible.
File completion and the review decision are easy to conflate.	Mark viewed updates file progress only. Submit review opens a separate decision dialog. Focus mode preserves position while hiding surrounding panels.

Interaction proof and scope

The prototype demonstrates J/K navigation, summary-to-code selection, Unified/Split views, Z focus mode, reversible viewed status, local comment drafts, and simulated submission. The four alternative product workflows are optional explorations, not the primary submission. Shortcuts are ignored while typing. Below 1280 px, context opens as an overlay.

Evidence and limits

The supplied screenshots show coderabbitai/mono #22041, with two layers and three files. The linked live Formbricks PR is a different 52-file example; its public review checks were rate limited. This comparison consistently uses the screenshot's visible file. Code is transcribed with normalized wrapping and summaries are condensed. Missing code and original comment text are identified rather than reconstructed.

Desktop, keyboard, progress, dialog-focus, and recovery checks establish prototype behavior. No reviewer-speed improvement is claimed. Review decisions and drafts stay in the browser tab and are never sent.